

THE MOVE

Cue -> small move -> pause -> observe -> follow or release. -> Is it more X, or more Y — or something else? -> Is it more timing or workload? -> Short version or the detailed one — or neither right now? -> Would email or a quick call be easier?

START HERE

Offer two clear paths with a way out: "Is it more X, or more Y — or something else?"

SAY THIS

Quick	<i>"Is it more X, or more Y?"</i>
Warm / low-pressure	<i>"No rush — is it more the timing, or more the workload?"</i>
Work / meetings / email	<i>"Is the blocker mainly clarity, or capacity?"</i>
Narrowing a vague a...	<i>"Is it more timing or workload?"</i>
Softening and the es...	<i>"We can stay with this, or move on — your call."</i>
Pressure / conflict	<i>"Before we go further — is this a today problem, or a this-week problem?"</i>

AVOID

- The person needs an open field, not a narrowed one
- You are disguising your preferred answer as a choice
- Neither option is genuinely acceptable

REMEMBER

Two options should reduce effort, not remove freedom.